

Monty Stratton Set For Saint-Miller Game

MINNEAPOLIS, Minn.—Monty Stratton, whose brilliant baseball career was tragically cut short by a shotgun blast, will be one of the topline old-timers who'll appear in the second-annual Saints-Millers Old-Timers Game at Metropolitan Stadium July 16.

Stratton, whose life was portrayed by James Stewart in the film, "The Monty Stratton Story" was a St. Paul Saint in 1935, before moving on to major league fame with the Chicago White Sox. Just as he'd reached the stature of perhaps the top righthand pitcher in the American League, Stratton accidentally shot off his right leg in a hunting accident in the fall of 1938.

Although he tried a comeback with the White Sox a couple of years later, Monty was no longer able to pitch in the major leagues. He did, however, effect a return to the game with Sherman, Tex., of the East Texas League, in 1946, winning 18 games and losing but 7. And he'll take his turn on the mound for the Saints in the up-coming Millers & Saints re-enactment, a week from Tuesday.

Since serving as technical adviser for MGM in the filming of

his life story in 1948, Monty has lived in retirement from the game as a farmer and rancher near Greenville, Tex.

Another old-timer who's accepted an invitation to play in this year's contest is former Minneapolis Miller hurler Carl Eng. Eng, a retired Minneapolis carpenter and builder, pitched for the Millers back in 1923 and '24.

Also in the fold are Minnesota Twins' scouts Angelo Giuliani and Johnny Mauer, who'll be the only holdovers from last year's Old-Timers Game to make a return appearance in '68.

The above four join the previously-announced Dick Williams, Eddie Popowski, Andy Cohen, Ollie Bejma, Gene Kelly and Lefty Johnson, who'll be in uniform for the 6:30 p.m., one-hour or three-inning contest.

All told, some 30 former American Association players with the Millers and the Saints are expected to take part in the game. The Saints won last year, 3-1.

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